the film relied on M.P. Sivagnanam's early biography of VOC. The emotional script was studded with Subramania Bharati's songs. Though a box-office failure the film was a critical success. With the government exempting the film from entertainment tax, over the years, it enjoyed successful reruns in cinema halls across the state, and VOC's fame reached the farthest corners of the Tamil world.

In the Tamil popular mind, *kappal* (ship) and *chekku* (the oil mill that he pulled in prison) have come in to stand for VOC's extraordinary achievements and peerless sacrifice.

In 2011, the Tuticorin Port Trust (now the Port Authority) was named after V.O. Chidambaram.